

CSE310: Compiler Sessional, January 2026 Term

ICG Online Assignment Practice

Absolute Value Built-in abs()

Time: 40 Mins

Total Marks: 10

Problem

Extend the expression grammar to support a built-in `abs()` function. It takes a single expression and returns its absolute (positive) value.

```
int a; a = -15; println(abs(a));
```

Task

- Modify the `factor` rule to support `abs(expression)`.
- Update the ICG visitor. After evaluating the inner expression, check if `EAX` is less than 0. If it is, negate `EAX` using the `NEG` instruction.

Mark Distribution

- Extending the grammar. (4)
- Assembly generation for conditional negation. (6)

Sample Input-Output

Input Program	Generated Sample Assembly (print library omitted)
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<pre> int main() { int a; a = 0 - 5; println(abs(a)); println(abs(10)); return 0; } </pre>	<pre> main: PUSH EBP MOV EBP, ESP SUB ESP, 4 MOV EAX, 0 MOV EDX, EAX MOV EAX, 5 SUB EDX, EAX MOV EAX, EDX MOV [EBP-4], EAX MOV EAX, [EBP-4] CMP EAX, 0 JGE .L1 NEG EAX .L1: CALL print_number MOV EAX, 10 CMP EAX, 0 JGE .L2 NEG EAX .L2: CALL print_number MOV EAX, 0 JMP .L3 .L3: ADD ESP, 4 POP EBP RET </pre>
Expected Output	<pre> 5 10 </pre>